Screening Report

Fundraising & Partnerships Manager

Taleemabad Talent Acquisition Agent • 05 March 2026

Total Applications: 64 | Assessed: 48 | Shortlisted/Assessed: 10 | Out of Budget: 6 | Budget: PKR 150,000 – 270,000 / month

1. Deep Comparative Analysis

Master ranking of ALL 48 assessed candidates — shortlisted, extended review, and no-hire pool — sorted by JD match score. Budget assessed separately and does not affect scores.

#	Candidate	Score	Tier	Budget	Exp. Salary	Experience	Current Role / Background	Key Strength / Why Not Shortlisted	Verdict
SHORTLISTED — 5 candidates recommended for interview consideration									
1	Danish Hussain	**97.5**	**Tier A**	**Out of Budget**	PKR 550,000 /month	~20 years	Head of Grants & Partnerships, INGO (Hyderabad)	PKR 1B+ mobilised — FCDO, World Bank, UNDP, ADB named. Highest single fundraising track record in pool.	**RECOMMEND — budget exception required**
2	Zain Ul Abideen	**95.0**	**Tier A**	**Out of Budget**	PKR 350,000 /month	~10 years	Deputy Manager Resource Mobilisation, READ Foundation (Islamabad)	US $50M lifetime across two orgs (READ + SPO). Dual-org sequential success confirms repeatable system. Islamabad-based, smallest budget gap of any OOB candidate.	**INTERVIEW — negotiate salary**
3	Mizhgan Kirmani	**78.8**	**Tier B**	**In Budget**	PKR 250,000 /month	~8 years	Manager, Donor Relations — The Citizens Foundation (TCF), Islamabad	In-budget, Islamabad-based, active FCDO/UN Women/UNDP/USAID/Green Climate Fund relationships. PKR 72M closed in FY. Best risk-adjusted hire in pool.	**INTERVIEW — priority**
4	Arsalan Ashraf	**72.2**	**Tier B**	**Out of Budget**	PKR 450,000 /month	~12 years	Director of Fundraising & Business Development, NGO (Karachi)	Built fundraising functions from scratch at 3 separate NGOs — clearest builder track record for a zero-to-one mandate.	**CONSIDER — confirm relocation + negotiate**

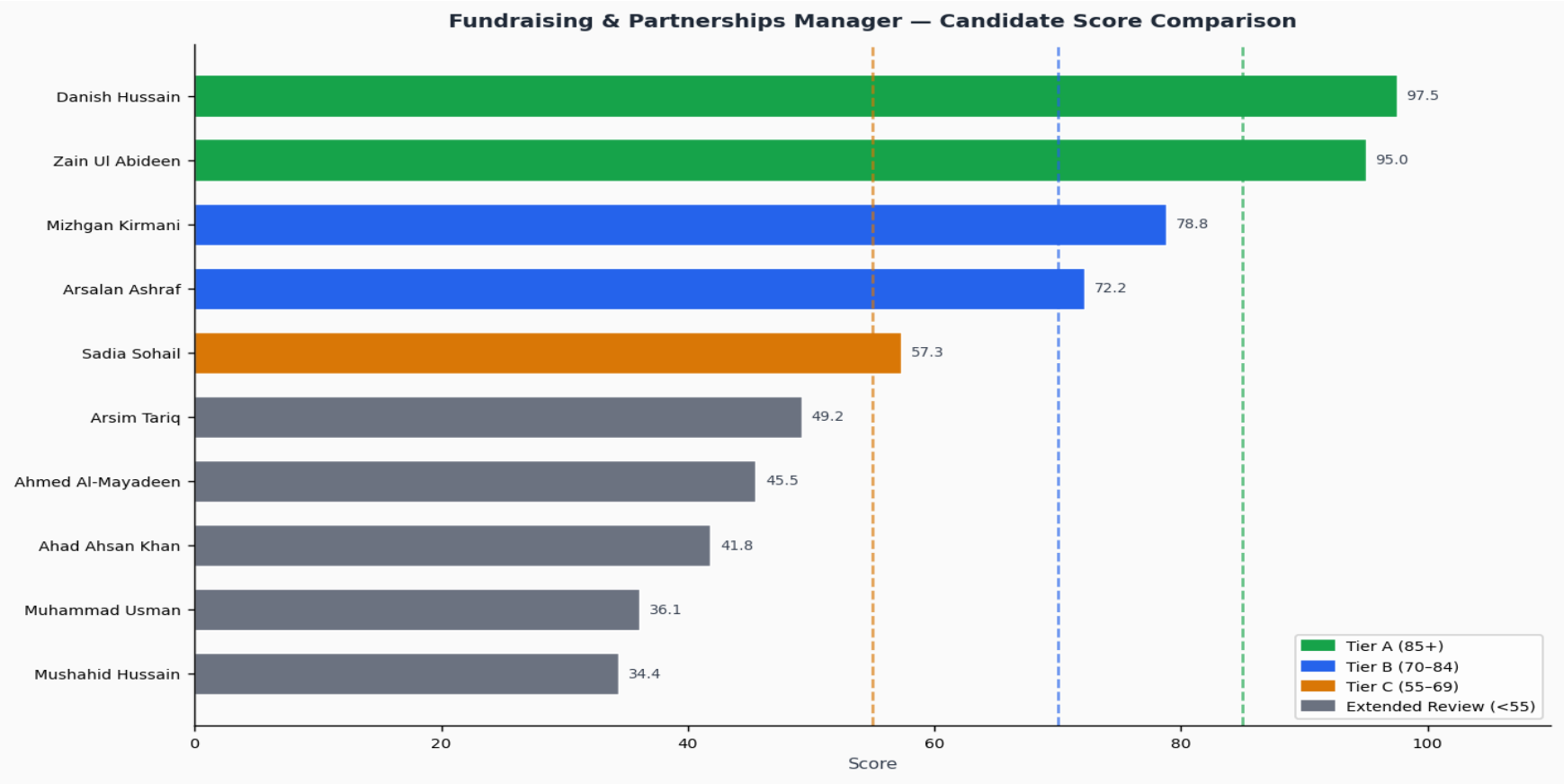
#	Candidate	Score	Tier	Budget	Exp. Salary	Experience	Current Role / Background	Key Strength / Why Not Shortlisted	Verdict
5	Sadia Sohail	57.3	Tier C	In Budget	PKR 140,000 /month	~8 years	Donor Relations Officer, READ Foundation (Islamabad)	Most affordable in-budget option. 8 years donor relations at READ Foundation (Taleemabad peer). 3 fundraising certifications.	**LOW PRIORITY — growth hire only**
EXTENDED REVIEW — 5 candidates with partial fit; not ready for Year-1 acquisition mandate									
6	Arsim Tariq	49.2	Extended Review	Borderline	PKR 280,000 –300,000/month	~10 years	Programme Manager / M&E; Lead (FCDO & World Bank projects, Islamabad)	Deepest sector context in Extended Review — 10 years on FCDO and World Bank-funded contracts; contributed to winning proposals.	**EXTENDED REVIEW**
7	Ahmed Al-Mayadeen	45.5	Extended Review	Out of Budget	~PKR 980,000/month	~10 years	Fundraising Lead, International NGO (Yemen-based)	Elite international fundraising — UN agencies, multi-million dollar scale. Harvard Business School credential. Strongest functional scores after Danish and Zain.	**NOT VIABLE — geo + budget**
8	Ahad Ahsan Khan	41.8	Extended Review	Out of Budget	PKR 550,000 /month	~9 years	Manager Grants, Aga Khan University (AKU), Islamabad	$134M portfolio across 210 active grants at AKU. World Bank HEDP lead. Deepest grants compliance expertise in pool.	**NOT SUITABLE — wrong function**
9	Muhammad Usman	36.1	Extended Review	Out of Budget	PKR 350,000 /month	~18 years	Public Affairs & Development Alliances Lead (Rawalpindi/Islamabad)	18 years government relations and international development alliance experience. Islamabad-area based.	**NOT SUITABLE — no evidence**
10	Mushahid Hussain	34.4	Extended Review	In Budget	PKR 170,000 /month	~4 years	Donor Reporting Officer, READ Foundation (Islamabad)	READ Foundation pedigree. In-budget at PKR 170K. Manages financial reporting to donors.	**NOT SUITABLE — junior/reporting only**
NO-HIRE — 38 candidates not shortlisted. Representative sample shown below.									
11	Mohammad Aqeel Qureshi	33	No-Hire	—	—	—	Manager Fundraising, Shifa Foundation (healthcare NGO, Islamabad)	Fundraising in healthcare/WASH domestic NGO — no multilateral/bilateral grant track record. Shifa donor base is domestic/charity, not USAID/FCDO/WB.	Not Suitable
12	Faheem Baig	31	No-Hire	—	—	—	Programme Implementation Officer, Development Sector NGO (Rawalpindi)	Programme implementation — not fundraising acquisition. No BD ownership evidenced. Delivery is the opposite function from donor acquisition.	Not Suitable

#	Candidate	Score	Tier	Budget	Exp. Salary	Experience	Current Role / Background	Key Strength / Why Not Shortlisted	Verdict
13	Shahzad Saleem Abbasi	30	No-Hire	—	—	—	Head of BD, Fundraising & Policy — Junior Jinnah Trust (Islamabad)	PKR 400M annually — but entirely domestic charity/CSR model. Donors are individuals and corporates, NOT multilateral/bilateral institutional donors.	Not Suitable
14	Hamdan Ahmad	29	No-Hire	—	—	—	Programme Manager, World Bank-Funded Programme (Islamabad)	Programme management on donor contracts — managing an awarded WB grant is not the same as winning one. No independently won proposals cited.	Not Suitable
15	Shakir Manzoor	27	No-Hire	—	—	—	Fundraising Support / Grants Assistant, Development NGO (Rawalpindi)	Supporting role — no evidence of independently owning acquisition pipeline or closing grants.	Not Suitable
16	Sarmad Iqbal	27	No-Hire	—	—	—	Head – Policy Advocacy & Strategic Partnerships, Int'l Development Org (Islamabad)	B2G/governance strategy — policy advocacy is distinct from multilateral grant proposal writing and closing.	Not Suitable
20	Bareera Rauf	22	No-Hire	—	—	—	Junior BD/Fundraising Officer, Development NGO	Less than 3 years experience, no independently closed grants, no multilateral donor relationships.	Not Suitable
25	Mahnoor Mellu	18	No-Hire	—	—	—	Marketing Executive, Corporate Sector	Corporate marketing background — no development sector, no grant writing, no donor relationship experience. Entirely unrelated function.	Not Suitable
35	Imran Sarwar	12	No-Hire	—	—	—	Sales Manager, FMCG	FMCG sales — no development sector exposure, no institutional fundraising. Applied to wrong role category.	Not Suitable
48	Adnan Ali	8	No-Hire	—	—	—	Unreadable CV (scanned, OCR failed)	CV was a scanned image — OCR could not recover sufficient text to score the candidate. Flagged for re-submission.	Not Suitable

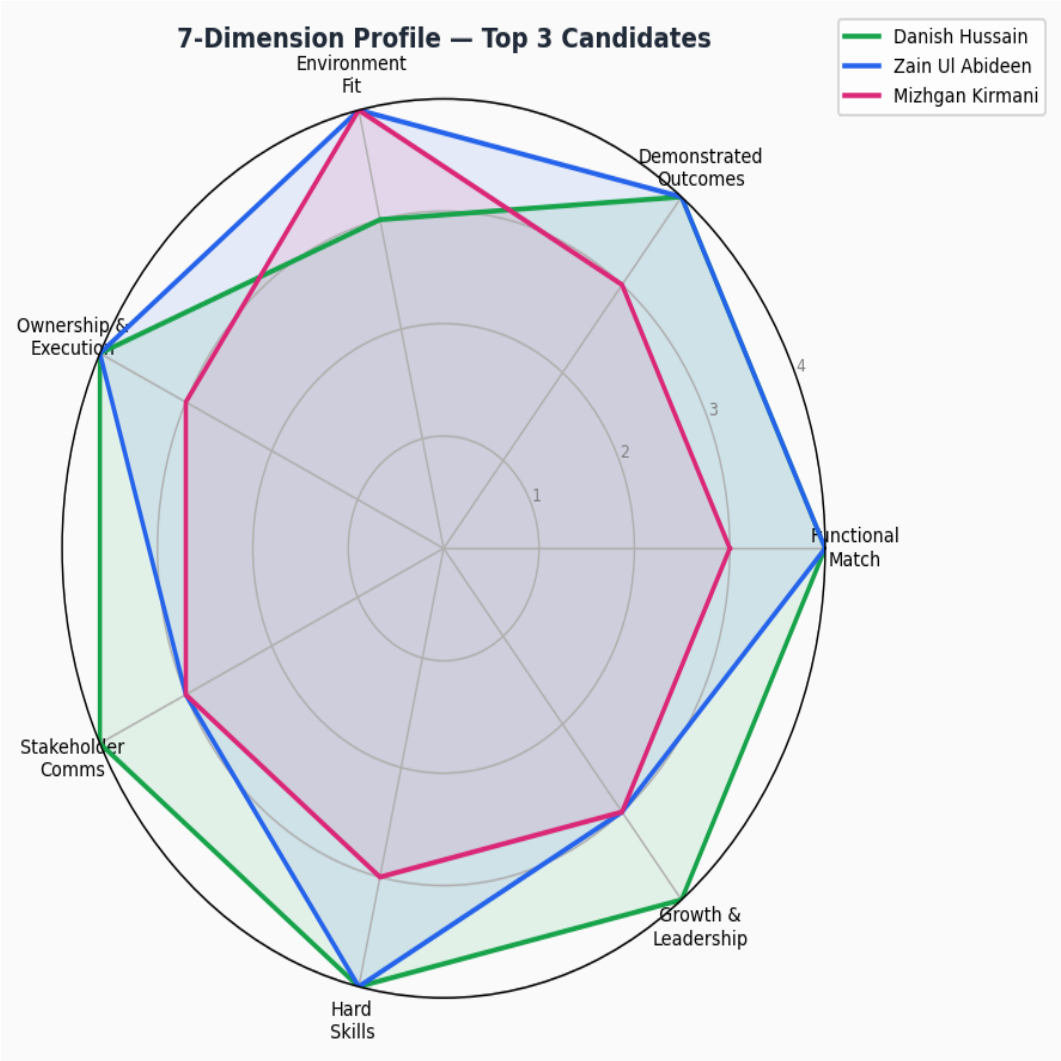
+ 28 additional no-hire candidates not individually listed here. Categories: Unrelated Background (15) · Sector-Adjacent (11) · Wrong Sector (6) · Junior Profile (5) · Could Not Assess (1).

2. Visual Analytics — Charts

Bar Chart — Score Comparison (All 10 Assessed Candidates)



Radar Chart — 7-Dimension Profile (Top 3 Candidates)


7-Dimension Profile — Top 3 Candidates
Danish Hussain
Zain Ul Abideen
Mizhgan Kirmani
Environment Fit
Demonstrated Outcomes
Functional Match
Growth & Leadership
Hard Skills
Stakeholder Comms
Ownership & Execution
1
2
3
4

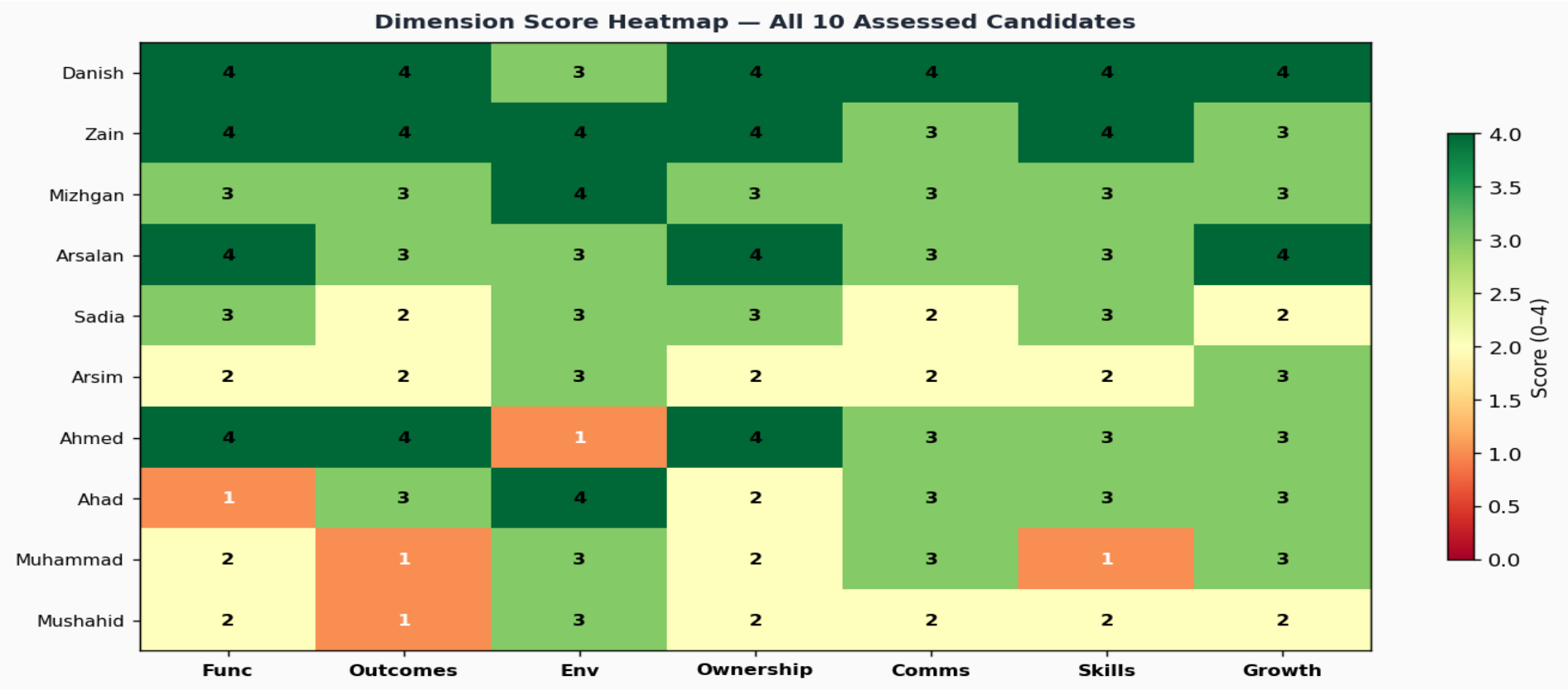
3. Strong Match but Out of Budget

These candidates scored strongly on JD fit but their stated salary exceeds the PKR 270,000/month ceiling. Flagged for hiring manager review. Consider if budget flexibility exists or a base + performance structure is possible.

#	Candidate	Score	Tier	Stated Salary	Current Role	Why Flagged / Recommendation
1	Danish Hussain	97.5	Tier A	PKR 550,000/month	Head of Grants & Partnerships, INGO (Hyderabad)	Hyderabad-based (willing to relocate — confirm in writing). PKR 550K ask is 2× budget ceiling.
2	Zain Ul Abideen	95.0	Tier A	PKR 350,000/month	Deputy Manager Resource Mobilisation, READ Foundation (Islamabad)	PKR 350K is PKR 80K above ceiling — smallest gap, most negotiable. WASH/humanitarian sector dominant — EdTech pivot required.
4	Arsalan Ashraf	72.2	Tier B	PKR 450,000/month	Director of Fundraising & Business Development, NGO (Karachi)	Corporate CSR / foundation focus — limited multilateral USAID/WB/FCDO experience. PKR 450K is PKR 180K above ceiling. Karachi-based.
7	Ahmed Al-Mayadeen	45.5	Extended Review	~PKR 980,000/month	Fundraising Lead, International NGO (Yemen-based)	Yemen-based — no willingness to relocate stated. MENA region focus — zero Pakistan donor landscape knowledge. PKR 980K is 3.6× budget ceiling.
8	Ahad Ahsan Khan	41.8	Extended Review	PKR 550,000/month	Manager Grants, Aga Khan University (AKU), Islamabad	Grants administration and compliance — NOT acquisition. JD explicitly lists this as a failure condition. PKR 550K above budget.
9	Muhammad Usman	36.1	Extended Review	PKR 350,000/month	Public Affairs & Development Alliances Lead (Rawalpindi/Islamabad)	Zero quantified fundraising outcomes across 18 years. No specific grants won or amounts raised cited. Government relations vs. acquisition function mismatch.

4. Visual Analytics — Heatmap

7-dimension score heatmap for all 10 assessed candidates (scores 0–4 per dimension).



5. Why Others Did Not Make the Cut

Out of 48 assessed candidates, 38 were not shortlisted. Key patterns across the no-hire pool:

Category	Why Not Shortlisted
Unrelated Background (15)	Marketing, sales, FMCG, IT, admin, HR professionals who applied to the wrong role. Zero fundraising acquisition background.
Sector-Adjacent (11)	Programme managers, M&E; officers, grants compliance — all working near fundraising but never owning the acquisition function independently.
Wrong Sector (6)	Genuine fundraisers but in domestic charity/CSR or healthcare/WASH contexts — fundamentally different donor landscapes (individual donors vs. multilateral/bilateral).
Junior Profile (5)	< 3 years experience, no independently closed grants, not ready for Year-1 $500K–$1M+ acquisition mandate.
Could Not Assess (1)	CV was a scanned image — OCR could not recover sufficient text for scoring. Candidate should resubmit an editable CV.

Recommended Next Steps

1. Confirm Mizhgan Kirmani (#3) for priority interview — in-budget, Islamabad-based, active FCDO/UNDP/USAID relationships. Best risk-adjusted hire.
2. Escalate Danish Hussain (#1) and Zain Ul Abideen (#2) to leadership — both over budget but strongest fundraising track records in pool.
3. Explore base + performance structure with Zain Ul Abideen (PKR 80K gap is smallest and most negotiable).
4. Confirm relocation commitment from Danish Hussain (Hyderabad) in writing before scheduling interview.
5. Re-advertise if Mizhgan Kirmani does not progress — Sadia Sohail (#5) is an affordable in-budget option but requires 6-month ramp-up.